Safexpress Centre for Data, Learning and Decision Sciences

Experimental subseasonal forecast guidance for India

Forecast initialization: 9 September 2026

Forecast period: 9 September to 6 October 2026 | Weeks 1 to 4

Forecast product: IFS operational initialization | 100-member ensemble mean

Status: Experimental research guidance for forecast assessment, not an operational warning

Executive summary

The 9 September initialization indicates a shifting rainfall pattern across India. Week 1 favors above-normal rainfall over Gujarat and adjoining western India, with a narrower wet band extending through parts of central India toward Odisha. Much of the west coast, southern peninsula and eastern to northeastern sector is below normal. Week 2 brings broader rainfall suppression across northern and central India, while positive anomalies develop over the southern peninsula and nearby low-latitude seas.

Week 3 shows renewed above-normal rainfall over parts of the central and southern peninsula, the Bay of Bengal, and sections of the Himalayan foothill and northeastern belt. Stronger anomalous westerly flow south of India accompanies this recovery. By Week 4, rainfall anomalies weaken over most of the country; a modest dry signal remains near the east coast and northwestern Bay of Bengal.

Temperatures are relatively cool across much of northern and central India in Week 1, with warmth over the southern interior. Warm anomalies shift into central and west-central India from Week 2 onward. The combined fields support weakening of the monsoon flow during Weeks 1–2 followed by a Week 3 reorganization.

Forecast week	Valid period in 2026
Week 1	9–15 September
Week 2	16–22 September
Week 3	23–29 September
Week 4	30 September–6 October

Weekly rainfall anomaly

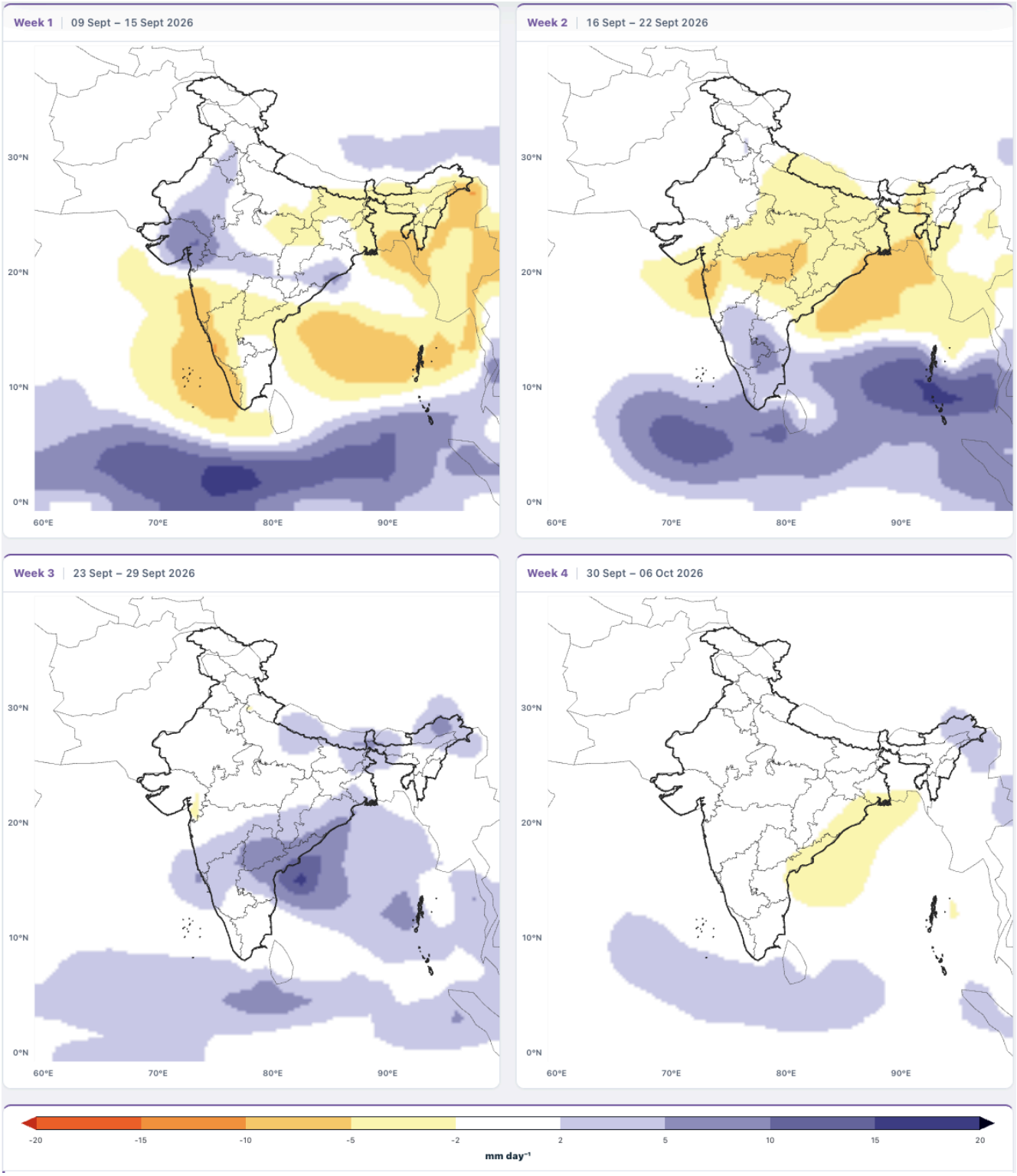


Figure 1. Weekly mean rainfall departures in mm day⁻¹.

850 hPa wind anomaly

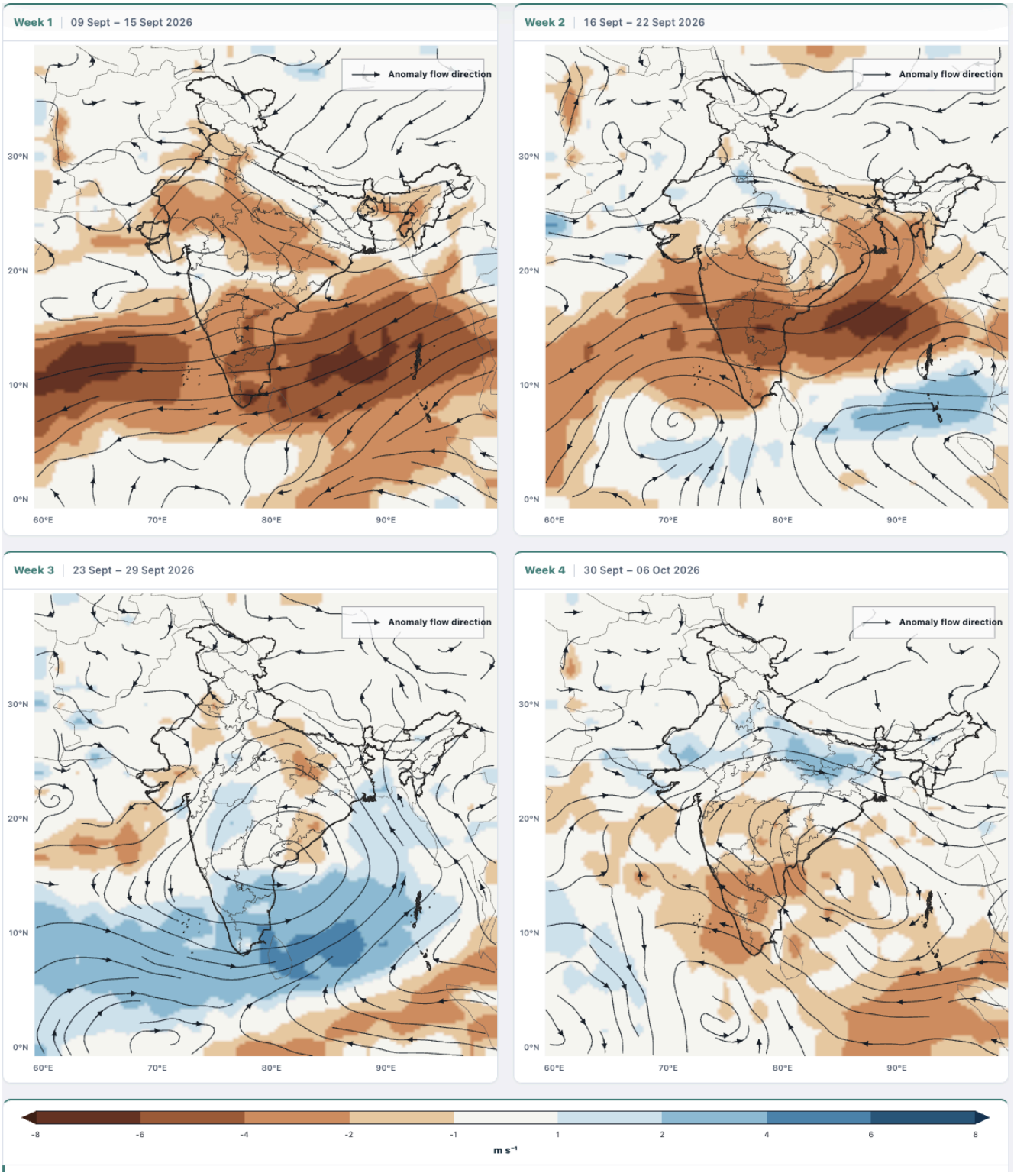


Figure 2. Shading shows weekly wind-speed anomalies in m s^{-1}

Weekly mean temperature anomaly

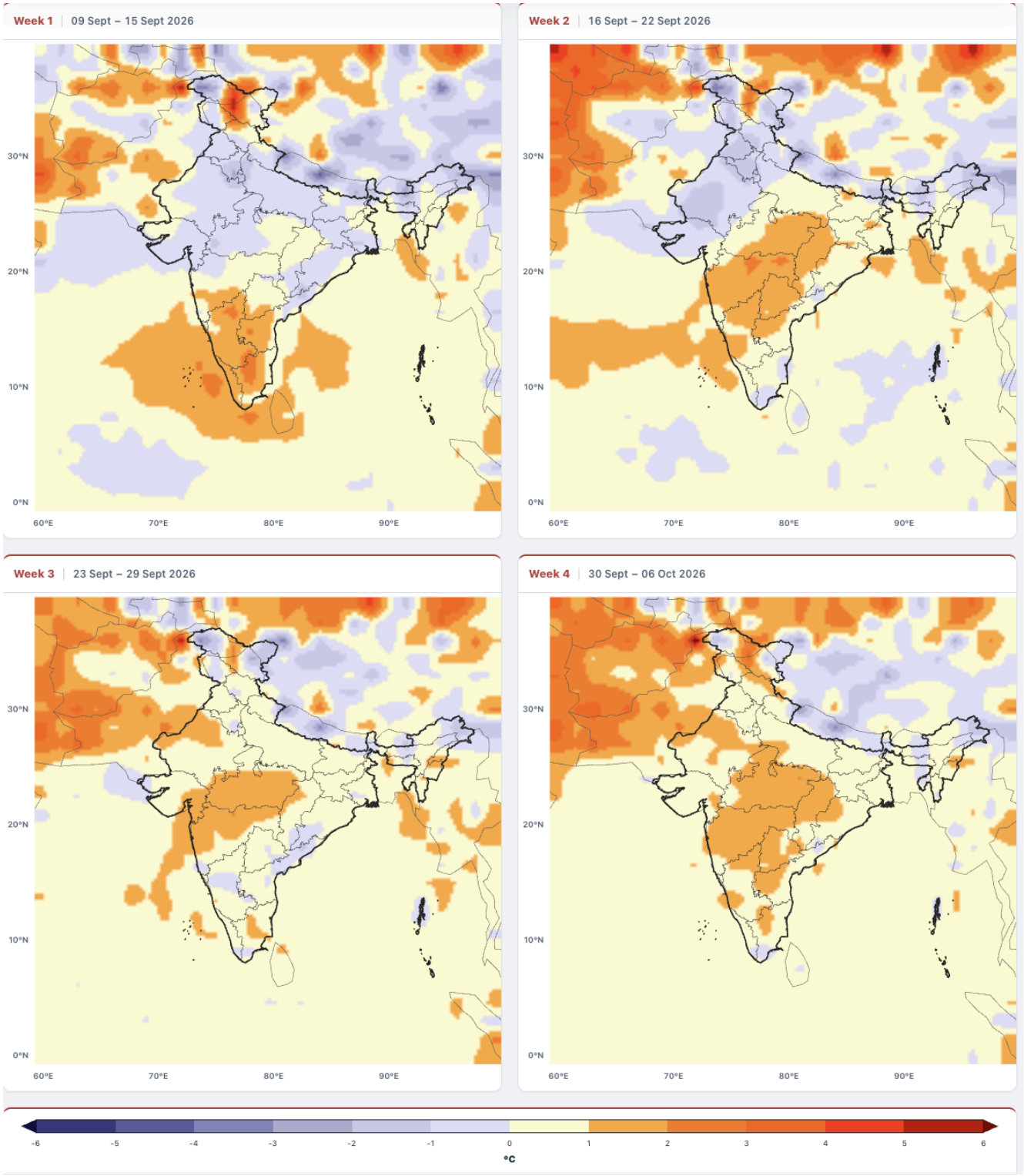


Figure 3. Weekly mean 2-m temperature anomalies

Methodology

The forecast comprises four consecutive seven-day means initialized on 9 September 2026. The source identifies an IFS operational initialization and a 100-member ensemble mean.

Rainfall is the mean daily rate within each week, in mm day^{-1}. Its anomaly indicates the departure from that reference rate. Temperature is the mean of seven daily-mean 2-m temperature fields. The anomaly is expressed in °C. Wind anomalies are in m/s.

Key S2S signals

- Week 1 retains a wet Gujarat and adjoining central-Indian signal despite weakened low-level monsoon flow over much of the peninsula.
- Week 2 is the clearest period of widespread rainfall suppression over northern and central India; the southern peninsula is an exception.
- Week 3 combines renewed peninsular rainfall enhancement with stronger low-level flow south of India and into the Bay of Bengal.
- Week 4 has weak rainfall departures over most of India, while central and west-central temperature anomalies remain positive.
- The latest cycle revises several earlier rainfall signals for the same valid dates, particularly 9–15 September.

Appendix A Weekly mean rainfall

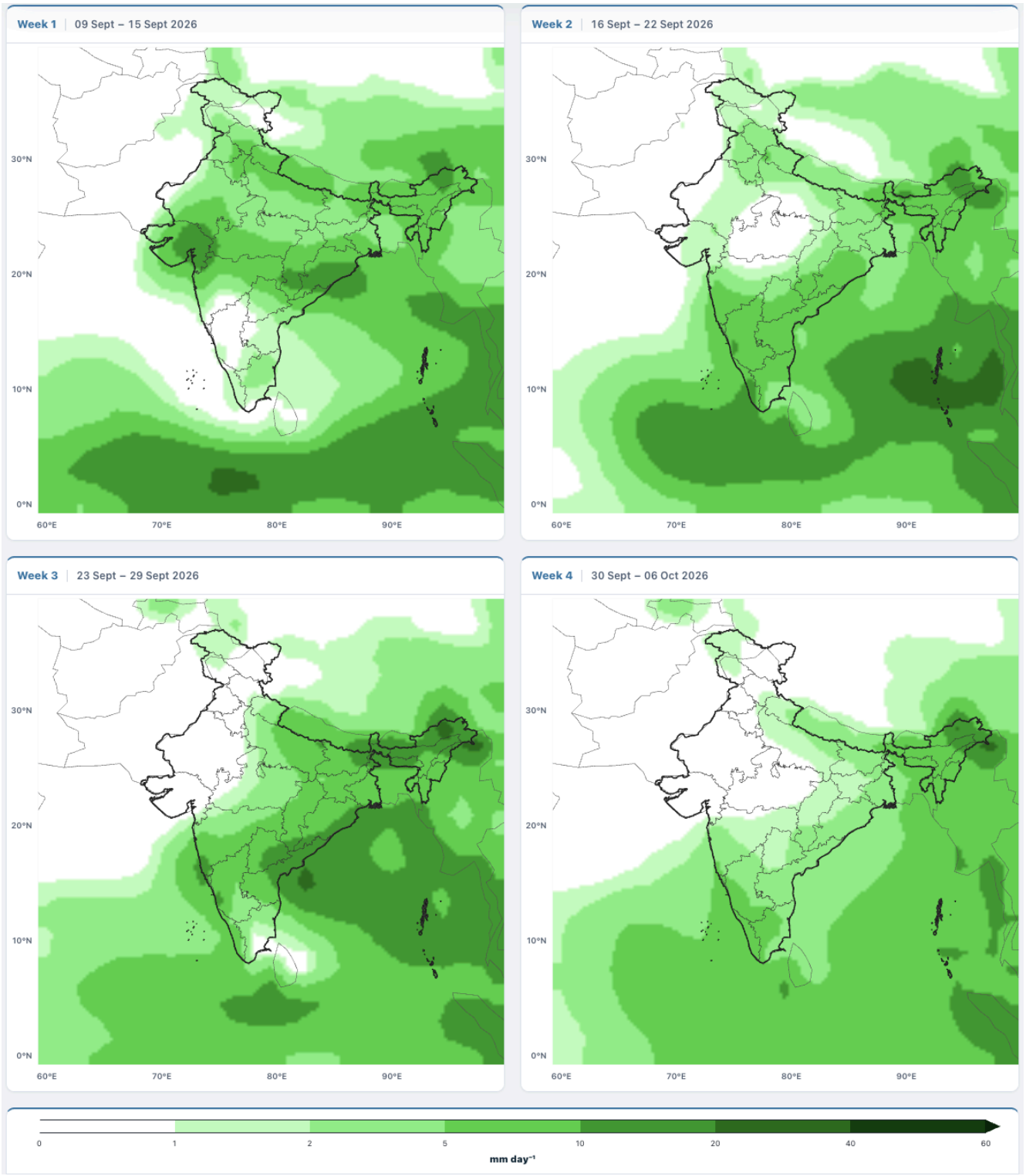


Figure 4. Mean daily rainfall rate in mm day^{-1} over each seven-day forecast week

Appendix B Weekly mean temperature

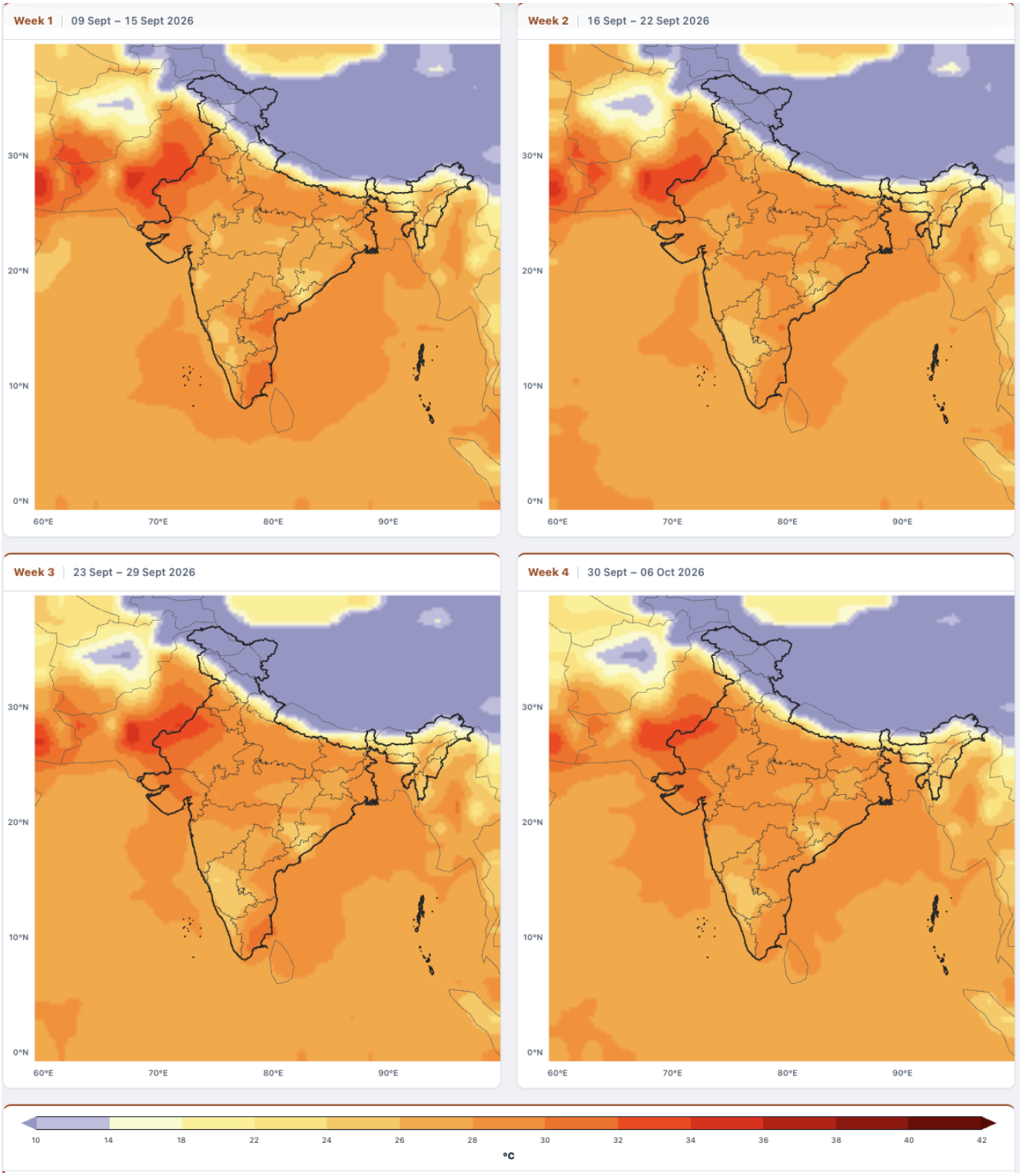


Figure 5. Mean of seven daily-mean 2-m temperature fields, in °C.